

WORD SEARCH

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Word Search - Ancient Rome

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3 puzzles · Medium · World UNESCO Monuments · Serie 01

PUZZLE GAMES PRESS

DIGITAL GIFT · SCAN THE QR

Instructions

Find all the hidden words in the grid. Words can be horizontal, vertical or diagonal, in any direction. Cross off each word when found. Solutions at the back.

The word search puzzle is a relatively young invention: it was created by Norman E. Gibat, who published the first one in a puzzle-book called the Selenby Digest in Norman, Oklahoma, back in 1968. It caught on quickly because, unlike crosswords, it required no vocabulary knowledge — just sharp eyes. That "sharp eyes" skill is exactly why word searches are still recommended today: scanning a grid to spot a target word among distractors trains visual search and sustained attention, a skill that is one of the first to decline with age, which is why occupational therapists frequently use word search puzzles in cognitive rehabilitation programs.

Tip: Spending 15-20 minutes a day on cognitive activities improves concentration, memory and overall wellbeing.

The Twelve Tables: Rome's First Written Law Code

◆ Roman Forum, Rome — 450 BC ◆

	CENTURY ENACTED 450 BC
	TABLES OF LAW Twelve Tables
	SOCIAL CLASS TARGETED Plebeians
	LANGUAGE USED Latin

The Twelve Tables: Rome's First Written Law Code

ROMAN FORUM, ROME — 450 BC

* HISTORY

Before 450 BC, Roman law existed only in the memories of patrician priests who could twist it against the poor at will. Plebeian citizens, tired of arbitrary judgments, demanded that the rules be written down for everyone to see. The Senate sent a commission of ten men — the decemviri — to Greece to study the laws of Solon, and upon their return they inscribed Rome's first legal code onto twelve bronze tablets and mounted them publicly in the Forum. Every Roman schoolboy was required to memorize the Twelve Tables word for word.

The code covered everything from debt repayment schedules to property boundaries, inheritance rights, and even the maximum permissible extravagance at funerals. Table III specified that a creditor could sell an insolvent debtor into slavery across the Tiber River — a chilling reminder that ancient rights had brutal edges. Table XI, controversially, banned marriage between patricians and plebeians, a prohibition repealed just four years later under pressure.

The Twelve Tables matter because they established a principle that would shape Western civilization for two millennia: law must be visible, fixed, and equally accessible to all citizens. Roman jurists of the classical period, and ultimately the compilers of Emperor Justinian's Corpus Juris Civilis in AD 533, traced their entire tradition back to these bronze tablets. Modern legal concepts — innocent until proven guilty, the right to confront accusers — have roots tangled in those twelve simple bronze...

* CURIOUS FACTS

-  The decemviri commission traveled to Athens around 454 BC specifically to study Solonian law before drafting the Tables.
-  Table VIII set the fine for breaking another person's bone at 300 asses if the victim was a free man, only 150 if a slave.
-  The original bronze tablets were destroyed when the Gauls sacked Rome in 390 BC; scholars reconstruct the text from later Roman writers quoting it.
-  Cicero wrote in 50 BC that Roman children in his day still chanted the Twelve Tables from memory as a school exercise.



DID YOU KNOW?

One clause of the Twelve Tables permitted a father to sell his own son into slavery up to three times — only after the third sale did the son become legally free of paternal authority.

The Twelve Tables: Rome's First Written Law Code

Roman Forum, Rome — 450 BC

Y	E	K	R	Y	R	E	V	A	L	S	U	O	T	V
L	Y	O	M	T	B	L	U	T	X	S	I	V	S	W
U	P	P	R	R	B	U	R	C	M	N	D	M	T	P
E	E	L	O	M	F	O	L	W	H	N	O	U	A	I
S	L	N	E	G	T	O	P	E	A	I	E	R	T	L
F	Z	I	S	B	Z	R	R	I	D	R	B	C	U	T
E	N	G	E	K	E	I	C	U	B	I	A	R	T	S
E	P	D	U	U	T	I	I	O	M	V	D	F	E	I
D	T	K	I	A	R	K	A	W	T	M	F	F	C	R
U	L	G	N	T	A	H	V	N	P	E	O	M	K	U
N	N	C	A	D	E	J	S	O	Q	C	L	F	K	J
Z	E	P	W	R	C	H	F	Y	W	E	K	B	K	X
I	N	Z	V	I	V	A	Z	O	Z	D	Y	F	A	D
V	Q	R	G	I	Y	Q	D	G	E	B	J	A	J	T
F	Z	C	R	E	D	I	T	O	R	U	O	P	M	X

✦ FIND THESE WORDS ✦

INHERITANCE DECEMVIRI PATRICIAN PLEBEIAN CREDITOR SLAVERY STATUTE TABLET
DEBTOR BRONZE JURIST FORUM

Pompeii Buried: The Day Vesuvius Froze a Roman City

◆ Pompeii, Campania — AD 79 ◆



ERUPTION DATE
August 24, AD 79



ESTIMATED DEATHS
2,000+ at Pompeii



CITY POPULATION
11,000 residents



ASH DEPTH
Up to 6 meters

Pompeii Buried: The Day Vesuvius Froze a Roman City

POMPEII, CAMPANIA — AD 79

* HISTORY

Shortly after midday on August 24, AD 79, a column of volcanic debris shot eighteen miles into the sky above Mount Vesuvius. Residents of Pompeii, a prosperous Roman port town of roughly 11,000 people, watched pumice stones begin raining down like hail. Many fled immediately; others sheltered indoors, convinced the worst would pass. By the following morning, a series of pyroclastic surges — superheated clouds of gas and ash traveling at 100 miles per hour — had entombed the city beneath up to six meters of volcanic material. Time stopped. Breakfast dishes sat on tables. A chained dog died where it lay. A baker's carbonized loaves remained in his oven.

The younger Pliny, staying seventeen miles away at Misenum, watched his uncle Pliny the Elder sail toward the disaster to attempt a rescue — and die there, overcome by fumes near Stabiae. The nephew's two letters to historian Tacitus, written decades later, are the only eyewitness literary account of the eruption and remain among the most vivid disaster narratives in classical literature.

Pompeii was not rediscovered until 1748, when Spanish engineer Roque Joaquín de Alcubierre began excavations under Bourbon patronage. What emerged was extraordinary: an entire Roman city with frescoes still brilliant in color, election slogans painted on walls, graffiti declaring love and insults, and the hollow plaster casts of victims preserved in their final postures. Pompeii gives historians a three-dimensional snapshot of Roman daily life...

* CURIOUS FACTS



Archaeologists have injected plaster into cavities left by decomposed bodies since 1863, creating eerily lifelike casts of Pompeii's victims.



The eruption of Vesuvius in AD 79 released energy estimated at 100,000 times that of the Hiroshima atomic bomb.



Pompeii's streets show deep ruts worn by cart wheels, and stepping stones allowed pedestrians to cross without walking through sewage.



Over 11,000 square meters of Pompeii remain unexcavated as of 2024, deliberately preserved for future technology to study.



DID YOU KNOW?

Pompeii's walls contain more than 11,000 pieces of surviving graffiti, including political campaign slogans, sports scores, and one inscription that simply reads 'Sanius was here.'

Pompeii Buried: The Day Vesuvius Froze a Roman City

Pompeii, Campania — AD 79

B	H	R	A	D	X	Q	P	O	M	P	E	I	I	W
C	Q	A	M	D	V	C	D	J	H	J	E	L	I	J
F	X	M	U	E	N	A	L	U	C	R	E	H	F	S
Z	J	C	U	U	G	S	F	X	W	X	W	J	P	W
P	U	Z	S	S	V	C	N	N	R	N	Z	Y	L	T
S	P	J	P	W	S	E	C	C	O	L	R	Y	E	E
G	U	Q	A	C	F	C	S	I	O	O	I	C	X	C
O	M	T	H	I	D	M	T	U	C	P	I	D	C	I
T	M	I	I	V	N	P	Y	L	V	M	R	J	A	N
R	O	M	T	C	U	A	A	K	U	I	G	L	V	A
W	C	G	C	R	A	S	P	P	M	L	U	X	A	C
A	S	Y	E	L	T	T	H	M	L	N	T	S	T	L
P	E	N	U	I	Z	J	X	S	A	S	E	F	I	O
U	R	V	C	T	C	O	T	X	M	C	X	R	O	V
F	F	M	Z	O	P	L	A	S	T	E	R	N	N	E

✦ FIND THESE WORDS ✦

PYROCLASTIC HERCULANEUM EXCAVATION VESUVIUS ERUPTION CAMPANIA VOLCANIC
POMPEII PLASTER TACITUS FRESCO PUMICE

The Roman Road Network: Engineering an Empire Mile by Mile

◆ Roman Empire — 312 BC — AD 400 ◆



TOTAL NETWORK LENGTH
80,000+ kilometers



ROAD WIDTH STANDARD
4.2 meters minimum



PROVINCES CONNECTED
All 50 provinces



KEY BUILDING TOOL
Roman pickaxe

The Roman Road Network: Engineering an Empire Mile by Mile

ROMAN EMPIRE — 312 BC — AD 400

* HISTORY

Construction of the Via Appia began in 312 BC under censor Appius Claudius Caecus, cutting 132 miles south from Rome to Capua across marshes and hills that had previously slowed armies to a crawl. The Romans paved it with hand-fitted polygonal basalt stones so precisely shaped that no mortar was needed, and many of those original stones survive under Italian asphalt today. This single road became the model for what would eventually stretch over 80,000 kilometers — enough to circle the Earth twice — binding Britain to Mesopotamia under Roman administration.

Roman road-building crews worked in disciplined layers. Workers first dug a trench up to a meter deep, then packed it with a foundation of large stones, a middle layer of crushed rubble and lime concrete, and finally a surface of fitted stone or compacted gravel. Roads were crowned — slightly arched in the cross-section — so rainwater drained to side ditches rather than pooling. Milestone markers placed every Roman mile (approximately 1,481 meters) showed the distance to Rome itself, reinforcing the maxim that all roads led there.

The strategic and economic consequences were immense. A Roman legion could march 25 miles per day on a good road; messengers in the Imperial Cursus Publicus postal system averaged 50 miles daily and in emergencies reached 170 miles in 24 hours. Olive oil, grain, Spanish silver, and African ivory moved with a reliability that pre-Roman Europe had never known. When the roads crumbled after the fifth...

* CURIOUS FACTS

The Roman Road Network: Engineering an Empire Mile by Mile

Roman Empire — 312 BC — AD 400

H	T	R	Y	W	U	U	C	R	C	R	R	M	F	O
E	S	C	Y	X	A	B	F	N	U	X	I	L	F	M
M	O	Z	U	C	P	K	I	P	N	O	I	G	E	L
J	B	Z	I	D	O	J	D	R	A	I	N	A	G	E
S	A	T	J	O	A	B	E	T	S	I	D	E	M	Z
U	S	I	W	R	G	I	B	B	Y	Z	S	I	F	I
S	A	M	I	P	C	Z	V	L	K	Z	L	M	Z	J
R	L	W	E	E	P	L	Q	R	E	E	T	G	O	W
U	T	H	D	Y	Q	R	O	B	S	S	Z	Z	E	O
C	C	A	P	U	A	Y	L	T	K	B	T	Z	H	E
R	J	I	B	H	E	V	O	E	E	O	I	O	P	I
T	F	V	B	V	R	N	X	T	V	H	P	J	N	A
V	B	S	R	B	E	V	W	L	W	A	G	L	Y	E
P	M	U	U	K	M	V	R	N	G	H	R	N	G	G
R	S	T	N	E	M	E	V	A	P	D	U	G	V	B

✦ FIND THESE WORDS ✦

COBBLESTONE MILESTONE DRAINAGE PAVEMENT SURVEYOR VIADUCT BASALT CURSUS
LEGION GRAVEL CAPUA

— SOLUTIONS —

#1 The Twelve Tables: Rome's First Written Law Code

Y	E	K	R	Y	R	E	V	A	L	S	U	O	T	V
L	Y	O	M	T	B	L	U	T	X	S	I	V	S	W
U	P	P	R	R	B	U	R	C	M	N	D	M	T	P
E	E	L	O	M	F	O	L	W	H	N	O	U	A	I
S	L	N	E	G	T	O	P	E	A	I	E	R	T	L
F	Z	I	S	B	Z	R	R	I	D	R	B	C	U	T
E	N	G	E	K	E	I	C	U	B	I	A	R	T	S
E	P	D	U	U	T	I	I	O	M	V	D	F	E	I
D	T	K	I	A	R	K	A	W	T	M	F	F	C	R
U	L	G	N	T	A	H	V	N	P	E	O	M	K	U
N	N	C	A	D	E	J	S	O	Q	C	L	F	K	J
Z	E	P	W	R	C	H	F	Y	W	E	K	B	K	X
I	N	Z	V	I	V	A	Z	O	Z	D	Y	F	A	D
V	Q	R	G	I	Y	Q	D	G	E	B	J	A	J	T
F	Z	C	R	E	D	I	T	O	R	U	O	P	M	X

#2 Pompeii Buried: The Day Vesuvius Froze a Roman City

B	H	R	A	D	X	Q	P	O	M	P	E	I	I	W
C	Q	A	M	D	V	C	D	J	H	J	E	L	I	J
F	X	M	U	E	N	A	L	U	C	R	E	H	F	S
Z	J	C	U	U	G	S	F	X	W	X	W	J	P	W
P	U	Z	S	S	V	C	N	N	R	N	Z	Y	L	T
S	P	J	P	W	S	E	C	C	O	L	R	Y	E	E
G	U	Q	A	C	F	C	S	I	O	O	I	C	X	C
O	M	T	H	I	D	M	T	U	C	P	I	D	C	I
T	M	I	I	V	N	P	Y	L	V	M	R	J	A	N
R	O	M	T	C	U	A	A	K	U	I	G	L	V	A
W	C	G	C	R	A	S	P	P	M	L	U	X	A	C
A	S	Y	E	L	T	T	H	M	L	N	T	S	T	L
P	E	N	U	I	Z	J	X	S	A	S	E	F	I	O
U	R	V	C	T	C	O	T	X	M	C	X	R	O	V
F	F	M	Z	O	P	L	A	S	T	E	R	N	N	E

#3 The Roman Road Network: Engineering an Empire Mile by Mile

H	T	R	Y	W	U	U	C	R	C	R	R	M	F	O
E	S	C	Y	X	A	B	F	N	U	X	I	L	F	M
M	O	Z	U	C	P	K	I	P	N	O	I	G	E	L
J	B	Z	I	D	O	J	D	R	A	I	N	A	G	E
S	A	T	J	O	A	B	E	T	S	I	D	E	M	Z
U	S	I	W	R	G	I	B	B	Y	Z	S	I	F	I
S	A	M	I	P	C	Z	V	L	K	Z	L	M	Z	J
R	L	W	E	E	P	L	Q	R	E	E	T	G	O	W
U	T	H	D	Y	Q	R	O	B	S	S	Z	Z	E	O
C	C	A	P	U	A	Y	L	T	K	B	T	Z	H	E
R	J	I	B	H	E	V	O	E	E	O	I	O	P	I
T	F	V	B	V	R	N	X	T	V	H	P	J	N	A
V	B	S	R	B	E	V	W	L	W	A	G	L	Y	E
P	M	U	U	K	M	V	R	N	G	H	R	N	G	G
R	S	T	N	E	M	E	V	A	P	D	U	G	V	B



Word Search - Ancient Rome

by Puzzle Games Press



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— **Puzzle Games Press**